Ben Morris

Postdoctoral Fellow | Department of Psychology | Yale University
Email: benjamin.morris@yale.edu

Present Appointment

NSF Postdoctoral Fellow, Department of Psychology
Yale University, Computational Social Cognition Lab (*PI*: Julian Jara-Ettinger)

Education

PhD **University of Chicago**, Psychology 2024
Advisor: Alex Shaw

MA **University of Chicago**, Psychology 2021
Advisors: Alex Shaw & Daniel Yurovsky

MPhil **University of Cambridge**, King's College, Developmental Psychology 2016
Graduated with Academic Distinction
Advisor: Claire Hughes

BA **Reed College**, Psychology 2015
Graduated Phi Beta Kappa
Advisor: Jennifer Henderlong Corpus

Honors & Awards

National Science Foundation SBE Postdoctoral Fellowship (NSF SPRF)	2025-27
Provost Dissertation Fellowship Award	2023-24
Ruth Sosis Memorial Fellowship for Service	2023
Dewey Lectureship Teaching Award	2023
Norman H. Anderson Grant	2019, 2021, 2023
Academic Distinction, University of Cambridge	2016
Sperling Studentship, University of Cambridge	2015-16
Phi Beta Kappa, Reed College	2015
Opportunity Grant, Reed College	2015
Initiative Grant in Undergraduate Research, Reed College	2015
Commendation for Excellence for Academic Performance, Reed College	2011-15
CSLI Summer Fellowship, Stanford University	2014
ONPRC Summer Fellowship, Oregon Health and Science University	2013

Publications

In prep

Morris, B., Wang, Z., & Jara-Ettinger, J. (in prep). Everyday Task Demands.

Morris, B., & Shaw, A. (in prep). "Oh! Um. . . Sure": Children and adults use other's linguistic surprisal to reason about expectations and learn stereotypes.

***Morris, B.,** *Suwal, U., Lin, Q., Rubio-Fernandez, R., & Jara-Ettinger, J. (in prep). Speakers strategically adjust their image descriptions based on perceived memorability.

Submitted or Under Review

*Bergey, C., ***Morris, B., &** Yurovsky, D. (invited revision). Language selectively encodes atypical features of the world. *Nature Communications*.

*Hok, H., ***Morris, B.,** & Shaw, A. (under review). Fair Rules, Unfair Use:

Children negatively evaluate inconsistent rule use.

Morris, B., & Yurovsky, D. (invited revision). A communicative framework for early word learning. *Psychological Review*.

Published **Morris, B.,** Shaw, A., & Liberman, Z. (in press). Calibrated deference: Children's evaluations of responses to disagreement across knowledge gaps. *Cognition*.

Morris, B., Yurovsky, D., & Shaw, A. (in press). "Um…" Thinking out loud: Children infer social meaning from speech disfluencies. *Child Development.*

*Suwal, U., ***Morris, B.,** Lin, Q., Rubio-Fernandez, R., & Jara-Ettinger, J. (2025). Speakers strategically adjust their descriptions based on perceived memorability. In *Proceedings of the 47th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society.*

Morris, B., & Shaw, A. (2024). "Oh! Um. . . Sure": Children and adults use other's linguistic surprisal to reason about expectations and learn stereotypes. In *Proceedings of the 46th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society.*

*Leung, A.C., ***Morris, B.**, & Yurovsky, D. (2021). Children know what words other children know. In *Proceedings of the 43rd Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society.*

*Bergey, C.A., ***Morris, B.**, & Yurovsky, D. (2020). Children hear more about what is atypical than what is typical. In *Proceedings of the 42nd Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society.*

ManyBabies Consortium (2020). Quantifying sources of variability in infancy research using the infant-directed speech preference. *Advances in Methods and Practices in Psychological Science*.

Morris, B. & Yurovsky, D. (2019). Pressure to communicate across knowledge asymmetries leads to pedagogically supportive language input. In *Proceedings of the 41st Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society.*

Invited Presentations

Developmental Speaker Series, New York University	2025
Social Learning Lab, Stanford University	2023
Language And Cognition Lab, Stanford University	2023
Department of Comparative Cultural Psychology, Max Planck Institute	2023
Computational Social Cognition Lab, Yale University	2022
Developmental Brown Bag, University of Wisconsin, Madison	2021
Markman Lab, Stanford University	2021

Teaching

Infant Communication (UChicago, Instructor of Record)	2024

Teaching Assistant

Human Language and Interaction (UChicago, Marisa Casillas)	2023
Introduction to Developmental Psychology (UChicago, Kate O'Doherty)	2022
Development of Social Cognition (UChicago, Katherine Kinzler)	2022
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	Development of Social Cognition (UChicago, Katherine Kinzler)	2021
	Developmental Psychology (Reed College, Jennifer Henderlong Corpus)	2015
	Research Design and Data Analysis (Reed College, Kathryn Oleson)	2015
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Guest Lecturer	Human Language and Interaction	2023
	The Psychology of Communication (Summer course for highschoolers)	2022, 2023
Pedagogical Development	Inclusive Teaching in Psychology (Workshop, Yale)	
	Equitable Teaching in the Social Sciences and Humanities (10 wk course, Yale)	
	CCTE 50000: Course Design and College Teaching (Semester Course, UChicago)	
	Individual Teaching Observation and Consultation (UChicago)	
	Teaching in the Age of AI (Workshop, UChicago)	
	Inclusive Teaching: Belonging, Structure, and Active Learning (UChicago)	
	Gamification for Higher Education (Workshop, UChicago)	
	Fundamentals of Teaching (4 wk course, UChicago)	
Service	**Diversity & Inclusion Committee,** *University of Chicago*	*2021- 2024*
	Travel & Research Committee, *University of Chicago*	*2018-2024*
	Student Peer Mentor, *University of Chicago*	*2019-2024*
	President - Psychology Grad Student Organization, *UChicago*	*2021-2022*
	Graduate Cross-Talks Co-Organizer, *University of Chicago*	*2021- 2022*
	ReproducibiliTea Co-Founder and Organizer, *University of Chicago.*	*2020- 2022*
	Graduate Society Social Secretary, *University of Cambridge*	*2015-2016*
	Teaching Consultant, *Reed College*, *Genetics and Genomics (Sarah Schaack)*	*2015*
	Head Student Teacher, *Portland Public Schools*	*2011-2015*
	Teaching Consultant, *Reed College*, *Ethnomusicology (Morgan Luker)*	*2014*
	Student Teacher, *Helen Gordon Child Development Center*	*2013-2014*
	Student Judicial Board Member, *Reed College*	*2013-2015*
	Peer Tutor, *Reed College, various courses*	*2012-2015*
Mentorship	Kate Choi, Summer Research Assistant (Yale University)	*Summer 2025*
	Sophie Lau, Undergraduate Honors Thesis (Yale University)	*2024-2025*
	Sooyoun Zong, Masters Thesis Student (University of Chicago)	*2023-2024*
	Emma Tung, Undergraduate Research Assistant (University of Chicago)	*2023-2024*
	Yibo Pan, Undergraduate Research Assistant (University of Chicago)	*2020-2023*
	Cassie Wilson, Undergraduate Research Assistant (University of Chicago)	*2020-2022*
	Madison Collins, Summer Research Assistant (University of Chicago)	*Summer 2020*
	Abbie Klein, Undergraduate Honors Thesis (University of Chicago)	*2019-2020*
	Madeline Meyers, Undergraduate Research Assistant (University of Chicago)	*2017-18*
	Emmi Russo, Undergraduate Honors Thesis (University of Chicago)	*2016-17*

Conference Presentations

Morris, B. & Shaw, A. (2025, April). Oh! Um. . . Sure": Children and adults use other's linguistic surprisal to reason about expectations and learn

stereotypes. Talk to presented at the Society for Research on Child Development, Minneapolis, MN.

Morris, B. & Shaw, A. (2024, July). Oh! Um. . . Sure": Children and adults use other's linguistic surprisal to reason about expectations and learn stereotypes. Talk presented at the Cognitive Science Society Annual Meeting, Rotterdam, NL.

*Leung, A.C., ***Morris, B.**, & Yurovsky, D. (2022, January). Children know what words other children know. Talk presented at the Budapest Conference on Cognitive Development, Online.

*Leung, A.C., ***Morris, B.**, & Yurovsky, D. (2021, July). Children know what words other children know. Talk presented at the Cognitive Science Society Annual Meeting, Online.

Morris, B. & Shaw, A. (2021, June). "Umm": When children do and do not use speech disfluencies to infer knowledge. Talk presented at the Society for Philosophy and Psychology, Online.

*Bergey, C.A., ***Morris, B.**, & Yurovsky, D. (2021, April). Children hear more about what is atypical than what is typical. Talk presented at the Society for Research on Child Development Biannual Meeting, Online.

Morris, B., Yurovsky, D. & Shaw, A. (2021, April). Children use speech disfluencies to make social inferences. Talk presented at the Society for Research on Child Development Biannual Meeting, Online.

*Bergey, C.A., ***Morris, B.**, & Yurovsky, D. (2020, July). Children hear more about what is atypical than what is typical. Talk presented at the Cognitive Science Society Meeting, Online.

Morris, B., Appleby, E., Shadrach, L., Troxell-Whitman, Z., & Corpus, J.H. (2015, February). Gender dynamics in parent-to-child and child-to-parent attention-seeking behaviors. Talk presented at the annual meeting of the Oregon Academy of Science, Psychology section, Portland, OR.

Poster Presentations

Morris, B., & Shaw, A. (2024, March). "Umbrellas keep you dry": Children use listener design to infer others' knowledge. Poster presented at the Cognitive Development Society, Pasadena, CA.

Morris, B., & Shaw, A. (2023, March). "Umbrellas keep you dry": Children use listener design to infer others' knowledge. Poster presented at the Society for Research on Child Development, Salt Lake City, UT.

Morris, B., Yurovsky, D., & Shaw, A. (2022, April). The many meanings of "um": Children interpret disfluencies differently across contexts. Poster presented at the Cognitive Development Society Meeting, Madison, WI.

Morris, B. & Shaw, A. (2020, January). "Umm": When children do and do not use speech disfluencies to infer knowledge. Poster presented at the Budapest CEU Conference on Cognitive Development (BCCCD), Budapest, Hungary.

Morris, B., Bergey, C.A., & Yurovsky, D. (2019, October). Child language input does not reflect world frequency: Typical and atypical feature description

across development. Poster presented at the Cognitive Development Society Meeting, Louisville, KY.

Morris, B. & Yurovsky, D. (2019, July). Pressure to communicate across knowledge asymmetries leads to pedagogically supportive language input. Poster presented at the 41st Cognitive Science Society Meeting, Montreal, Canada.

Morris, B. & Yurovsky, D. (2018, July). Planning and communicative pressure leads to language input that supports learning. Poster presented at the 40th Cognitive Science Society Conference, Madison, WI.

Morris, B. & Yurovsky, D. (2018, May). Modeling the effect of communicative pressure on language input. Poster presented at the Midwest Cognitive Science Cognitive Science Conference, Bloomington, IN.

Morris, B. & Yurovsky, D. (2017, October). Communicative pressure can lead to language input that supports learning. Poster presented at the Cognitive Development Society Biennial Conference, Portland, OR.

Morris, B. & Corpus, J.H. (2016, April). Preschool children's learning and motivation in game-based learning contexts. Poster presented at the American Educational Research Association Annual Meeting, Washington, D.C.

*Both authors contributed equally.

Prior Research Experience

Communication and Learning Lab, PI: Daniel Yurovsky *2016-2018*
University of Chicago, Lab Manager

Centre for Family Research, PI: Claire Hughes *2015-2016*
University of Cambridge, Master's Student and Research Assistant

Children's Motivation Project, PI: Jennifer Henderlong Corpus *2013-2015*
Reed College, Undergraduate Thesis Student and Research Assistant

Language and Cognition Lab, PI: Michael C. Frank *Summer 2014*
Stanford University, CSLI Summer Intern (advised by Molly Lewis)

Oregon National Primate Research Center, PI: Christa Helms *Summer 2013*
Oregon Health and Science University, Summer Intern

Adolescent Health Research Program, PI: Kristen Anderson *2012-2013*
Reed College, Research Assistant